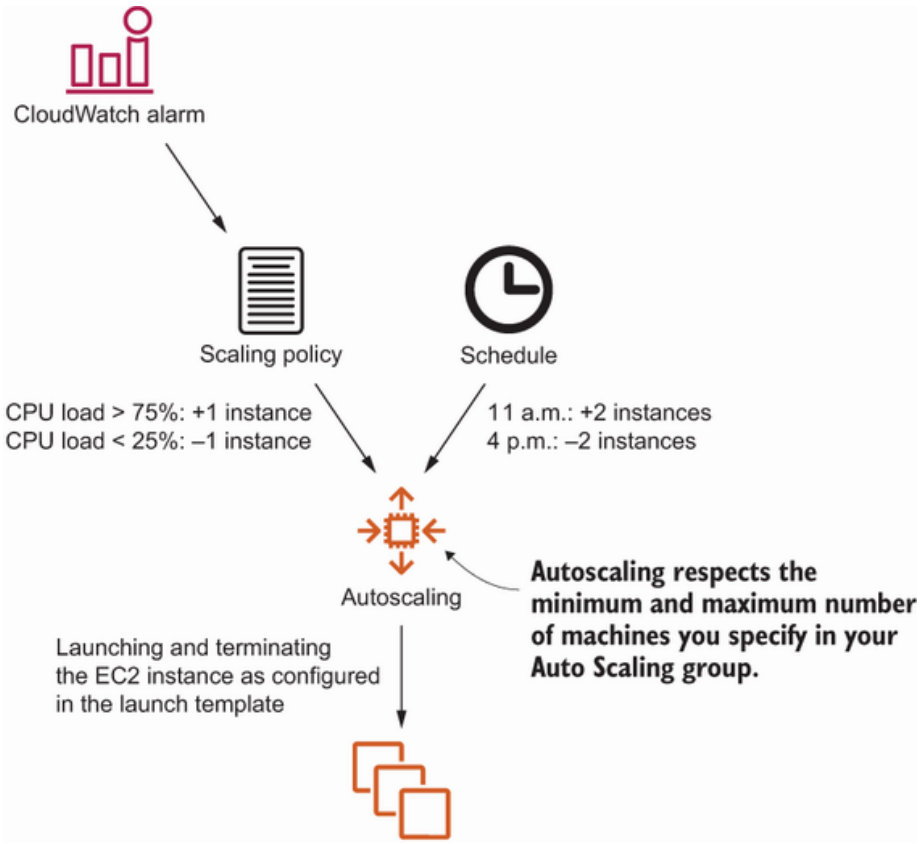


Figure 17.3 Triggering autoscaling based on CloudWatch alarms or schedules

Scaling based on a schedule is less complex than scaling based on a CloudWatch metric, because it's difficult to find a metric on which to scale reliably. On the other hand, scaling based on a schedule is less precise, because you have to overprovision your infrastructure to be able to handle unpredicted spikes in load.

17.2.1 Scaling based on a schedule

When operating a blogging platform, you might notice the following load patterns:

- *One-time actions*—Requests to your registration page increase heavily after you run a TV advertisement in the evening.
- *Recurring actions*—Many people seem to read articles during their lunch break, between 11 a.m. and 1 p.m.

Luckily, scheduled actions adjust your capacity with one-time or recurring actions. You can use different types of actions to react to both load pattern types.